

MORNING BRIEFING — TUESDAY, 25 AUGUST 2026

Generated pre-European-open · London time · Data collected via web search during this session (session run: morning of 25 Aug 2026, London). Figures sourced from live search results — some intraday levels may lag by minutes to hours; verify before trading.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

US Treasury unveils sweeping new Iran sanctions ("Operation Economic Outcast")

Source: CNBC, Reuters — collected ~07:00 London

Bessent detailed expanded sanctions targeting Iran's "enablers," including trading partners; oil pulled back from its spike as details emerged but geopolitical risk premium stays elevated into the European open.

Chip stocks sink on AI-infrastructure return doubts, Nasdaq underperforms

Source: CNBC, Yahoo Finance — collected ~07:00 London

Micron -5.8%, AMD and Broadcom down more than 3%/2% respectively Monday; signals a rotation out of high-multiple AI capex names that could carry into the European tech complex today.

US-Canada tariff tensions resurface alongside Iran sanctions overhang

Source: TheStreet — collected ~07:00 London

Adds a second trade-policy risk vector on top of the Iran sanctions news, keeping cross-asset risk sentiment cautious ahead of the open.

Fed Jackson Hole symposium opens Thursday, Chair Warsh speaks Friday

Source: Yahoo Finance, CNBC — collected ~07:00 London

Markets look for clarity on Warsh's inflation assessment and the "regime change" agenda he has floated for the Fed — the week's key rates catalyst.

German 10-year Bund yield sits near a 15-year high

Source: Trading Economics — collected ~07:00 London

Yield near 3.25-3.27% on debt-supply and inflation concerns, a headwind for European duration and a factor to watch into today's Bund trading.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

Collected ~07:15 London. Note: reliable today-specific futures prints were only available for Euro Stoxx 50; DAX/CAC/FTSE/US futures levels could not be cross-confirmed this session and are marked n/a — directional read taken from Monday's cash close and overnight tone instead.

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	EXPECTED MOVE
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	6,564 (day range 6,551–6,586, opened 6,580)	Flat-to-softer open indicated
DAX futures	n/a — not reliably sourced	Monday cash close -0.11%; cautious tone likely persists
CAC 40 futures	n/a — not reliably sourced	Monday cash close -0.32%; similar tone expected
FTSE 100 futures	n/a — not reliably sourced	Monday's outperformer (+close 10,856); watch for follow-through
S&P 500 futures (context)	n/a exact print	Recent sessions showed futures softer (~-0.3%) on chip weakness
Nasdaq futures (context)	n/a exact print	Recent sessions showed futures down ~-1% on AI capex doubts

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES (MONDAY 24 AUGUST)

Sources: 247wallst.com, Trading Economics — collected ~07:15 London

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50 / Stoxx 50	~6,450 (approx, unconfirmed)	~-0.2%
DAX 40	26,106.60	-0.11% (-29.96 pts)
CAC 40	n/a exact level	-0.32%
FTSE 100	10,856.31	Higher — best performer of the three

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (MONDAY 24 AUGUST)

Sources: Reuters/Washington Post, CNBC, Yahoo Finance — collected ~07:15 London

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,652.86	-0.28%
Dow Jones Industrial Average	53,417.16	+0.26% (+140.15 pts)
Nasdaq Composite	25,980.19	-0.76%

SESSION TONE & SECTOR TAKEAWAY

Mixed session: the Dow was the lone index in the green while the S&P and Nasdaq slipped as new US Iran sanctions and US-Canada tariff threats added to a risk-off tilt. Semiconductors led the decline — Micron -5.8%, AMD and Broadcom off more than 3% and 2% respectively — as investors questioned near-term returns on AI infrastructure spend. Key takeaway: rotation out of high-multiple AI capex names is the dominant theme heading into today, with geopolitics (Iran, tariffs) adding a secondary risk-off layer.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

Sources: aggregated wire reports — collected ~07:15 London. Note: freshest confirmed prints are from Monday 24 Aug session; some (Kospi, Nikkei) reference the prior Sunday-close comparison — treat exact overnight print for 25 Aug with caution.

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	n/a exact level for Tue	+0.27% (Mon session)
Hang Seng	n/a exact level for Tue	-1.84% (late Mon trade)
Shanghai Composite	n/a	n/a
CSI 300 (China, proxy)	4,563.13	-1.21%
Kospi	n/a exact level for Tue	-1.44% (Mon session)
ASX 200 (context)	n/a	+0.53%

tone & drivers

Broadly cautious-to-negative overnight tone in Greater China and Korea (Hang Seng, CSI 300, Kospi all lower), while Japan and Australia held up better. Iran sanctions detail and elevated US yields are the common thread weighing on regional risk appetite; Kospi's weakness in particular reflects continued chip-sector pressure following Monday's US semiconductor sell-off.

7. COMMODITIES

Sources: CNBC, Trading Economics, Investing.com — collected ~07:15 London

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE
Brent crude	\$92.06/bbl	-2.5%
WTI crude	\$84.89/bbl	-2.5%
Gold	\$4,645.74/oz	+0.83%
Natural gas (Dutch TTF, front month)	~€65.87/MWh (range €65.22-68.48)	n/a — source figures conflicting (€54-68 range seen); treat as indicative
Copper	\$6.58/lb	+0.05%

Oil eased Monday as markets awaited the specifics of the new Iran sanctions package rather than pricing further escalation; both benchmarks are still up sharply year-on-year (context: WTI/Brent had spiked earlier in August on Iran risk). Gold's advance (+0.83%, +38% YoY) reflects continued safe-haven demand amid geopolitical and inflation uncertainty.

8. RATES & FX

Sources: Federal Reserve H.15, Trading Economics, Bloomberg — collected ~07:15 London

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE/NOTE
US 10Y Treasury yield	4.72%	Close, 24 Aug
German 10Y Bund yield	~3.25-3.27%	Near 15-year high
EUR/USD	1.1682	+0.02% (24 Aug)
GBP/USD	~1.3643	Last confirmed print 21 Aug — stale, treat with caution
DXY (Dollar Index)	~99.60	Mid-Aug technical read; testing channel support below declining 200-day MA

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

Sources: GlobalCapital, IFR (search snippets only — full articles paywalled) — collected ~07:15 London

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES

n/a — no specific deal-level prints (issuer, size, coupon/spread) could be reliably sourced for Monday's session via open search. GlobalCapital/IFR primary-market coverage is behind a paywall.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY

n/a — no confirmed mandates for today's session found in open search. Broader recent GlobalCapital reporting flagged the euro corporate market "readying for an issuance burst," but this could not be confirmed as applying to this specific week.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main	n/a — no current print sourced	—
iTraxx Crossover	Last confirmed: ~318bps (mid-May 2026) — stale	—
CDX IG	n/a — no current print sourced	—
Avg euro corporate IG spread	n/a — no current print sourced	—

COMMENTARY

Recent GlobalCapital coverage points to a firm technical backdrop for euro IG — new-issue premiums (NIPs) have been compressing as order books "bulge," suggesting the window remains open and investor appetite is solid. That said, none of this could be confirmed as current for this specific session; treat the primary-market read as directional context only, not a same-day fact set. Skew toward industrials, transport, energy and financials per the standing mandate, but specific names are n/a today.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR (TODAY, 25 AUGUST)

Sources: Trading Economics, Scotiabank calendar — collected ~07:15 London. No Eurozone/UK releases were identified in open search for today; US calendar below (times converted to London, +5h vs ET as approximation for August DST overlap).

TIME (LONDON)	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
~14:00	S&P/Case-Shiller Home Price Index (Jun)	n/a	MEDIUM
~15:00	Richmond Fed Manufacturing Index (Aug)	n/a	MEDIUM
~15:00	New Home Sales (Jul)	n/a	MEDIUM
~15:00	Consumer Confidence (Aug)	n/a	HIGH
Eurozone / UK	No releases identified for today	n/a	—

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Yahoo Finance's earnings calendar shows roughly 42 companies reporting today, but specific names and tickers could not be confirmed via open search this session (n/a). Ongoing background: European Q2 bank earnings season remains strong (net profit +18% YoY across a large-cap sample); Deutsche Bank's results (revenue ahead of consensus, EPS below) and BNP Paribas's 33% profit beat continue to be reference points for sector sentiment. Check Yahoo Finance / MarketScreener earnings calendars directly for today's confirmed reporters.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Sources: aggregated broker-note and news coverage — collected ~07:15 London. Dates noted where coverage is not same-day.

Allegiant Travel (ALGT)	Aviation — upgraded to Outperform by Raymond James, PT \$116	Likely higher
Micron Technology	Semis — -5.8% Monday on AI-capex return doubts; momentum risk continues	Volatile / bias lower
AMD / Broadcom	Semis — down >3% / >2% Monday on same AI-infrastructure concerns	Volatile / bias lower
Deutsche Bank	Banks — trading steady post-Q2 (revenue beat, EPS miss); focus on capital strategy	Mixed / neutral
BNP Paribas	Banks — Q2 profit +33% YoY, beat forecasts	Likely supported
Huntington Ingalls Industries	Defense/Shipbuilding — \$2.2bn surveillance/intelligence contract (11 Aug, background context)	Supportive backdrop
General Dynamics	Defense — \$1.3bn Army National Guard cybersecurity contract (7 Aug, background context)	Supportive backdrop
Energy majors (Shell, BP, TotalEnergies)	Energy — Brent/WTI both -2.5% Monday as Iran sanction details emerged; specific stock-level moves n/a	Sector-level only, n/a specific direction

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed Jackson Hole symposium opens Thursday; Chair Warsh's Friday speech is the week's key rates catalyst, with markets watching for signals on his inflation view and proposed "regime change."

German 10Y Bund yield near a 15-year high (~3.25-3.27%) on debt-supply and inflation concerns; US 10Y at 4.72%, still elevated.

Key US data today: Consumer Confidence (high importance), Case-Shiller, Richmond Fed, New Home Sales.

CORPORATE

European bank Q2 earnings season strong: sample net profit +18% YoY; Deutsche Bank revenue beat but EPS missed; BNP Paribas profit +33%.

Chip-sector sell-off (Micron, AMD, Broadcom) on AI-infrastructure return doubts is the dominant single-sector story from Monday's US session.

Roughly 42 earnings releases scheduled globally today per Yahoo Finance calendar (specific names n/a).

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

US Treasury detailed "Operation Economic Outcast," a sweeping new Iran sanctions package targeting Iran's trading "enablers," including possible exposure for China.

US-Canada tariff tensions resurfaced alongside the Iran news, adding a second trade-policy risk thread.

Oil pulled back (-2.5% both benchmarks) as sanction details emerged rather than further escalation — a "sell the news" reaction so far.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

- 1. US data flow** — Case-Shiller, Consumer Confidence, New Home Sales set the tone for dollar and rates into the US open.
- 2. Iran sanctions detail** — Further clarity on "Operation Economic Outcast" scope could reprice oil and risk sentiment intraday.
- 3. Chip-sector follow-through** — Whether Monday's AI-capex-doubt sell-off (Micron, AMD, Broadcom) extends into European tech names.
- 4. European cash open** — FTSE outperformance vs DAX/CAC softness Monday — watch for continuation or reversal.
- 5. Positioning into Jackson Hole** — Rates desks likely trimming risk ahead of Thursday's symposium start.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

- 1. Jackson Hole symposium** — Chair Warsh's Friday speech is the single biggest rates catalyst of the week.
- 2. Iran sanctions rollout** — Implementation details and any Chinese response could move oil and broader risk sentiment.
- 3. US-Canada tariff talks** — A live trade-policy risk that could hit specific sectors (autos, industrials) this week.
- 4. European Q2 earnings continuing** — Bank and industrial results still due; sector momentum (positive so far) at stake.
- 5. German Bund supply/yield trajectory** — Yields near 15-year highs; further upside would pressure European risk assets broadly.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

- 1. Fed policy path into September FOMC** — Jackson Hole signals will frame rate expectations for the next meeting.
- 2. AI capex/infrastructure spending debate** — Continued doubt here is the biggest swing factor for tech-heavy indices.
- 3. Iran sanctions economic impact** — Effect on oil supply and pricing over coming weeks, feeding into inflation expectations.
- 4. European debt supply and curve steepening** — Bund and broader SSA issuance trends will keep pressuring long-end yields.
- 5. US-Canada / broader tariff developments** — Scope for escalation or resolution over the coming weeks, sector-specific risk.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

US Consumer Confidence and housing data could swing dollar/rates into the close. Any incremental Iran sanctions detail is a live risk-sentiment trigger. Watch chip-sector open in Europe for AI-capex-doubt spillover.

1 WEEK

Jackson Hole symposium (starts Thursday, Warsh speaks Friday) is the key appointment. Iran sanctions implementation and US-Canada tariff talks are the geopolitical/trade threads to track alongside continuing European earnings.

1 MONTH

September FOMC positioning post-Jackson Hole; the AI capex spending debate and its read-through to tech valuations; Bund/Treasury supply dynamics and yield trajectory; and the evolving economic impact of Iran sanctions on oil markets.

Sources: Reuters, CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Washington Post, TheStreet, Trading Economics, Investing.com, 247wallst.com, GlobalCapital, Federal Reserve (H.15), Bloomberg (search snippets), MarketScreener.

Data collected automatically via web search. Verify before making any decision.